



166 Wiki At Work



170 Linux vs Windows



190 Integrated Security

Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Case Study

Shifting Spaces

Preethi Chamikutty

Online businesses also need to engage in offline activities to supplement their business and facilitate growth

In a cutthroat market, it's essential for businesses to think of different ways to hold their own. As the Web space sees increasingly ruthless competition, businesses that were hitherto exclusively online, are now establishing an offline presence to ensure their survival and growth. In fact, Web sites such as Monster.com, Timesjobs.com and Shaadi.com among others are now vigorously supplementing their business with offline activities.

Shaadi.com attributes as much as 60 per cent of its growth to its offline initiatives. Timesjobs.com attributes its tagline—"fastest growing jobsite"—to its offline activities as well. The media plans of most large online businesses now include offline advertising and promotions as an integral part. However, this is not limited to advertising—offline events, too, play an important part.

In what follows, we have tried to analyse why companies that were once entirely dot-coms are focussing on offline areas of work as well? And why do they feel the need to look at offline methods at all.

The Need For Change

Over the past couple of decades, methods have been developed to precisely rate the effectiveness of various marketing platforms. And marketing on the Internet is not the same as marketing offline.

JuxtConsult, a research firm based in New Delhi, conducted a survey in April 2005 of Internet usage in India. They found that Internet penetration in India stands at a mere 2 per cent. The Internet in India is, for the most part, limited to the metros, with the percentage of rural Internet users being practically negligible. Also, over 50 per cent of Web users in Indian metros are between the ages of 19 and 30, and another 22 per cent between

